

CLE Internal Academic Integrity Approach

General Principles

1. Our CLE approach follows the University's regulations, which is fundamentally educational, striving to foster a strong ethical foundation among its students. Our goal is learning and we can give students opportunities to learn from experience.
2. We are dedicated to helping students build the understanding and skills necessary to uphold the academic integrity of their work. While supporting students is a priority, we also need to protect the academic standards of the University. Therefore, we will apply penalties for confirmed cases of academic misconduct.
3. The process for dealing with academic misconduct is designed to enable students to better understand the nature of academic misconduct and the high standards of academic integrity that are expected of them.
4. Course coordinators and instructors are committed to thoroughly investigating all allegations and having careful discussions with students about the circumstances of any offence before applying any penalties.
5. Course coordinators are responsible for posting the following message about academic integrity and plagiarism on the course Canvas site.

Academic Integrity

Students are expected to adhere to the university's academic integrity policy. Students are expected to uphold HKUST's Academic Honor Code and to maintain the highest standards of academic integrity. The University has zero tolerance of academic misconduct. Please refer to [Academic Integrity | HKUST – Academic Registry](#) for the University's definition of plagiarism and ways to avoid cheating and plagiarism.

Plagiarism

In CLE assignments, students should not copy from others nor submit the same work for multiple courses. Source materials must be explicitly acknowledged.

Assignments with evidence of plagiarism may score a zero and be followed up with your department's Dean. To demonstrate academic integrity and avoid plagiarism, you are expected to:

- paraphrase, summarize, reference and synthesize ideas from sources

- refrain from copying expressions and ideas directly from any source (e.g. from another student, or from a video, or from an article, etc.) without proper acknowledgement.

Handling Plagiarism and Other Forms of Academic Misconduct

1. We need to educate students on the value of academic integrity, the meaning of plagiarism and how to respect others' work and avoid plagiarism. Students should not copy from others nor submit the same work for multiple courses. Source materials must be explicitly acknowledged.
2. All student-written work should be submitted through Turnitin via Canvas. It is also possible to require students to submit scripts for presentations through Turnitin. We understand that judgments about plagiarism need to be made by human markers. Turnitin cannot completely substitute for an instructor's judgment.
3. We know that any conduct designed to mislead those responsible for making an assessment on a student's academic performance or standing is cheating and could be considered academic misconduct. In addition to plagiarism, such conduct may include using Gen AI and other tools as a substitute for a student's own work, misrepresenting one's level of proficiency to secure placement in a particular class, engaging in contract cheating (paying others to complete assignments) or assisting another individual in cheating.
4. All instructors should be vigilant in determining and dealing with plagiarism and other forms of academic misconduct.
5. For CLE courses including final examinations, the **HKUST Academic Honor Code** should be reprinted on the front cover of examination answer books and students should be asked to confirm the Declaration of Academic Integrity.
6. Students should maintain high integrity in the course selection process. For example, certain courses may require students to declare their proficiency level in a Language Background Survey.

Expected procedures where an instructor detects plagiarism or other irregularities in student's work

1. An instructor should ask the student to justify a high level of similarity in Turnitin or if the instructor has good reason to suspect malpractice. It is important that the student is allowed to explain how they created the work submitted. If the instructor is convinced

that the plagiarism or academic misconduct was intentional, possibly involving other students or contract cheating, they should contact the course coordinator(s) and provide the details and evidence of the suspected case, even if the student admits to malpractice.

2. The course coordinator(s) should examine all the information provided. If all parties are convinced that the plagiarism or academic misconduct was intentional, the course coordinator(s) will give the student not less than 3 working days' notice in writing of:
 - the allegation(s);
 - the details of all the piece(s) of work that will be discussed;
 - an invitation to an investigation meeting, specifying the date of the meeting.
3. The investigation meeting will be recorded and attended by the student, instructor and course coordinator(s) (and also Coordinator (Learning & Assessment) if needed). During the investigation meeting,
 - address all the allegations faced by the student;
 - ask the student whether the offence is admitted or denied;
 - allow the student an opportunity to explain how they created the work submitted;
 - provide an opportunity for the student to put forward evidence of any mitigating circumstances at the time of the assessment.
4. After the student has withdrawn from the investigation meeting, the course coordinator(s) will decide whether the student has committed an offence of academic misconduct, in consultation with the relevant instructor. The investigation meeting will be minuted by the course coordinator(s), recording the reasons and its findings.
5. For confirmed case of academic misconduct, the course coordinator(s) will determine the nature of the penalty and get endorsement from the Coordinator (Learning & Assessment) before notifying the student about the penalty. When deliberating on a penalty, course coordinator(s) must ensure that their decision is fair and proportional to the misconduct. According to [the University Resources for Staff Handling Academic Misconduct Cases](#), course coordinator(s) should consider taking the recommended actions/imposing the recommended sanctions for proven academic misconduct. Other available sanctions may also be imposed, commensurate with the nature of the misconduct. The penalty should also reflect whether the student has admitted malpractice and shows willingness to learn from their experience.
6. All cases of confirmed academic misconduct receiving penalty will be passed to the CLE Director. After taking into account the nature of the misconduct case and any relevant mitigating circumstances, the D/CLE will determine whether to submit a copy of the [Report on Student Academic Misconduct](#) to be lodged with the Academic Registrar for

record and reference. (The Coordinator, Learning & Assessment), and the relevant course coordinator(s), instructor and student will be notified of the D/CLE decision.)

7. If a copy of the [Report on Student Academic Misconduct](#) is lodged with the Academic Registrar for record and reference, other departments can view this record on the University 'Enquire Student Academic Misconduct Record' platform. The student will be awarded a grade of 'F', issuance of a formal written warning to be held on the student record until graduation, and (if handled by the Dean) request will be sent to the Academic Registrar to make a notation of academic misconduct on the transcript to remain in place for at least 1 term. A 2nd case of academic misconduct will be escalated to the Dean's level regardless of the nature of the case. There will be the award of a grade of "F", issuance of a formal written warning to be held permanently on the student record and request the Academic Registrar to make a permanent notation of academic misconduct on the transcript. A 3rd or subsequent case of academic misconduct will be escalated to the Senate Student Disciplinary Committee for consideration of appropriate sanction, with a recommendation for dismissal.